



Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

What would you do during a snowstorm?



Learning Outcome

Describe past experiences in a range of social and work contexts.

Ask your partner:

- Have you ever experienced a snowstorm? When?
- What do you think life would be like in your city if it snowed a lot?

Can Do Statements

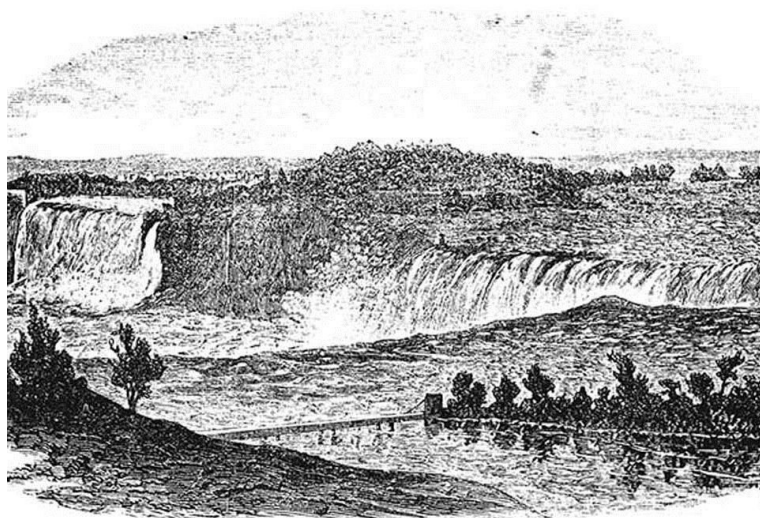
- I can talk about personal qualities.
- I can talk about people's past habits.
- I can offer advice and solutions.





Let's Explore!

Interesting conversations during a snowstorm



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

- Vanessa:** Wow. Niagara Falls is actually quite beautiful in the winter. I used to come here in the summer with my parents.
- Sally:** It's too bad we only booked two nights here. Checkout time is soon.
- Peter:** Oh, we'd better not go anywhere after all. A big snowstorm has just moved in.
- Vanessa:** But I've been scheduled to work tomorrow!
- Sally:** Luckily, my boss is pretty flexible. To be honest, I don't think we should be on the road under these conditions.
- Vanessa:** As a kid, I used to love playing outside in the snow all day.
- Peter:** We'd better book another night here, but we ought to do it now.
- Vanessa:** Oh, Peter, you're so decisive.
- Peter:** I'm just being realistic.
- Sally:** You might want to call Marco and put off lunch tomorrow.
- Vanessa:** Oh, that self-absorbed nincompoop isn't going to like that.
- Sally:** Last winter, we watched so many movies when Boston was snowed in.
- Peter:** I used to binge-watch TV shows with my brother on snow days. We would watch 24 back to back.
- Sally:** My old boyfriend used to be impulsive like that. We would watch all the *Bourne* movies in one day.



Let's Practice!

You find out more of people's inner qualities in a snowstorm.

Instructions: Select all the words in the sentence that describe a personal quality. Then read the sentences aloud with a partner. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

Word Bank

realistic / flexible / decisive / self-absorbed / nincompoop

1. My boss is pretty _____. He can give me a day off.
2. Peter was _____ in suggesting we stay another night.
3. He complained and started acting like a child. He can sometimes be a _____.
4. I'm just being _____ that we can't drive in a snowstorm.
5. Marco is so _____. He thinks he's more important.



Let's Practice!

What does the snow remind you of?

Instructions: Read the dialogue on page 2 again. Then read the question. Select the correct answer.

1. Has Vanessa been to Niagara Falls before?
 - a. This was her first time at Niagara Falls.
 - b. She came to Niagara Falls a few times before with her parents in the summer.
 - c. She has been to Niagara Falls once before.
2. Does Vanessa like the snow?
 - a. Vanessa doesn't like the cold.
 - b. Vanessa liked to play in the snow as a kid.
 - c. Vanessa thinks the snow is dangerous.
3. What did Peter use to do on snow days?
 - a. He would eat a lot with his brother.
 - b. He would watch TV 24 hours a day.
 - c. He would watch a lot of episodes of 24 in one day.





Extension Activity

What would you do if you couldn't go out in bad weather?

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Imagine that you are somewhere indoors with your friends when it's raining hard all day and night.
- Offer some advice to your friends on what they should do or not do. Use words for offering advice in your sentences.
- Write a list of activities including verbs that you could do together indoors.
- Exchange activity ideas with your partner. Communicate in English.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I write complete statements to offer advice and solutions.

☐ ☐

I compile a list of indoor activities with action words.

☐ ☐

I exchange ideas with my partner.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- **It's too bad** (expression): used to show that you are sorry or feel bad about something
e.g. Sally thought it was too bad they only booked two nights.
- **to schedule** (verb): To plan or organize something at a certain time
e.g. Vanessa has been scheduled to work tomorrow.
- **flexible** (adjective): when you are willing to change or try different things
e.g. The boss was very flexible when making the schedule.
- **realistic** (adjective): to see things as they really are
e.g. Peter was being realistic that they couldn't go home in the snowstorm.
- **self-absorbed** (adjective): to think only about yourself
e.g. Vanessa thinks that Marco is self-absorbed.
- **nincompoop** (noun): a foolish or stupid person
e.g. Sometimes Marco acts like a nincompoop.





Learning Points

Habits of the Past

Used to and *would* express a pattern of action that occurred regularly in the past.

Both *used to* and *would* are followed by the base form of a verb.

Subject + *used to* + verb

I used to take a walk everyday.

Subject + *would* + verb

I would walk 3 miles every evening.

Used to	Would
<i>I used to binge-watch TV shows with my brother on snow days.</i>	<i>We would watch all the episodes back to back.</i>
<i>My old boyfriend used to be impulsive</i>	<i>We would watch 3 movies in one day.</i>
<i>I used to love playing in the snow.</i>	<i>I would stay outside all afternoon.</i>

Had Better and Ought to for what is Advisable

You use the modals *had better* and *ought to* to give advice. You can also use *had better* to express a recommendation.

You can use the contraction *'d better* when you speak.

Ought to is a strong request or advice.

We ought to make a reservation soon = It's very good idea to do it.

Might want to is a suggestion

You might want to call Marco to put off lunch tomorrow = I suggest that you call Marco.

Had better can be used as a strong recommendation, or warning.

We'd better not drive anywhere in the snowstorm. = I strongly recommend that we not drive anywhere because it's dangerous.

Examples:

- *If you are thinking of staying here for another night, you ought to call your boss.*
- *We'd better book another night in this hotel if we need to stay here longer.*

